

HIGH SCHOOLS

BOYS DISTRICT BASKETBALL

Tigers' four-guard offense breaks down Lions defense

By MIKE PETICCA
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

The closer you get to the basket, the easier it should be to score.

That approach is what makes the Warrensville Heights boys basketball team so tough.

Few guards in the area can get inside the lane like the Tigers' Jawara "J.K." Brooks and Brian Swift.

Last night, Brooks and Swift scored 29 and 17 points, respectively, as Warrensville Heights defeated Orange, 71-63, in a district semifinal game at Solon's sold-out gymnasium.

The first-seeded Tigers (21-1), ranked second in The Plain

DIVISION II	
WARRENSVILLE HEIGHTS	71
ORANGE	63

Dealer Top 25 poll, will play fifth-ranked University School (20-2) for the Division II district championship on Saturday night. Second-seeded University defeated Kenston, 72-59, in the second game of last night's double-header.

Kendall Chones, a 6-6 junior forward, had 18 points and 13 rebounds for third-seeded Orange (18-4). But the Lions' young backcourt couldn't deal with the Warrensville Heights four-guard offense of seniors Brooks, Swift and Rich Yancy, and 6-5 sophomore

Demetrius Johnson. The Tigers round out their starting lineup with a defensive standout in the middle, 6-7 Lee Johnson.

"We thought their post play was excellent," Warrensville Heights coach Dennis Chimes said of Orange. "We knew, though, that we were much quicker."

Orange tried 2-3 and matchup zone defenses against the Tigers. Brooks and Swift combined to hit three early 3-point shots against the 2-3. Then, they started to go to the basket.

It wasn't simple, though, for the Tigers to shake the Lions. Kameron and Kyle Chones, the older brothers among the Chones' triplets, each scored 11 Orange

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DENNIS CHIMES, Warrensville Heights coach

points, with Kyle grabbing 10 rebounds. Andrew Lukich scored 10 points.

"We played a good ballgame," Orange coach Ron Hoyt said. "Their ability to penetrate, the

key to their team, ultimately made the difference."

Warrensville Heights led, 51-48, after a layup by Orange's Craig Fuller with seven minutes left. The Tigers went on a 10-1 run over the next three minutes, though, to lead, 61-49.

Swift fed Yancy for a layup and he hit a jumper in the lane. Brooks converted a layup after making a steal. Demetrius Johnson, who scored 12 points, canned two foul shots and Brooks hit a scoop shot from the lane.

University 72, Kenston 59 — Guard Logan White and guard-forward Tucker Kain scored 18 and 17 points, respectively, for the Preppers.

Kenston (11-12) stayed close most of the way, thanks largely to forwards Joe Motley and Robert Dubovec, who each scored 19.

Tyler Downing's three-point play cut the University lead to 58-53 with 5:30 left. But White hit two free throws and Dan Morrissey canned a 3-point shot and two free throws to up the Preppers' advantage to 65-53 with 2:30 left.

"We played a mediocre game defensively," University coach Tony Tucker said. "Normally we play four quarters of defense like we did during that little spurt. We're a team that thrives on our defense."

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BOYS BASKETBALL INSIDER

Upsets hit teams in AP top 10

By EDDIE DWYER
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

The mighty are falling. Heading into this weekend's district finals, six of the top 10 teams in the season's final Associated Press Division I boys basketball state poll have fallen by the wayside.

The sad six are second-ranked Cincinnati Winton Woods, third-ranked Mansfield, fourth-ranked Massillon Perry, seventh-ranked Toledo Libbey, ninth-ranked East Liverpool and 10th-ranked Central-Hover.

Jake Steuer and the unranked Stow Bulldogs overwhelmed Central-Hover, 71-47, on Tuesday night.

Division I has lost its seventh-, eighth- and ninth-ranked teams. The sixth-, 10th- and 12th-ranked teams in Division III have called it a season. And the state's second-, fourth-, fifth-, 13th- and 14th-ranked teams in Division IV have been eliminated.

PC POWER — Along with the solid season conference champion Strongsville can be proud of the performances of member schools Brecksville-Broadview Heights, Brunswick and North Royalton.

Under the direction of head coach Dave Murphy, North Royalton advanced to the Division I district semifinals at Baldwin-Wallace College and battled second-seeded Bedford down to the final four minutes before losing, 63-49. The Bears, closed their season at 13-9.

Brunswick will squelch off with top-seeded Strongsville in a Division I district semifinal at 8:15 tonight at Midview. Brecksville, led by savvy sophomore Grant Urbanski, took on Hudson last night in a Division I district semifinal at Copley. Strongsville will be attempting to defeat Brunswick for the third time this season, never an easy task.

Speaking of Strongsville, Mustangs senior point guard Nick Skully was chosen as the most valuable player in the Pioneer Conference. Skully, who averaged nearly 17 points and seven assists during the regular season, was joined on the conference's first team by teammates Bob Bossman and Dave Hutter.

HURRICANE WARNING — Led by Keith Aufmuth's 25 points, Brooklyn defeated defunct district champion Cuyahoga Valley Christian Academy, 50-45, Tuesday night.

Aufmuth, a 6-0 junior and a Plain Dealer Player of the Week this season, was recently selected as the MVP of the MAC-8. His 18.5 points per game during the regular season helped the Hurricanes (18-4) to their first outright conference title in boys basketball in 22 years.

UNSUING LANCER — Gilmour Academy senior Mike Panzica ended his three-year varsity basketball career by averaging 15.2 points and hitting 40 3-pointers this winter. During his three varsity seasons, Panzica totaled 716 points.

Last fall, Panzica broke Gilmour's single-season reception record in football by hauling in 57 passes.

RESPECT — Jed Dunn, who will guide his Brush High Arcs (18-3) against Shaker Heights (14-7) tonight at 6:30 in a Division I district semifinal at Cleveland-South, referred to the Raiders as "the king of kings" and Shaker coach Bob Wesson as a legend.

Do you think the young coach might be trying to set up the team from the Lake Erie League? Just kidding.

REMINDER — Because of the NCAA Division III women's basketball tournament, tomorrow night's Division I district championship game between St. Ignatius (20-2) and Bedford (16-6) has been moved from Baldwin-Wallace College to Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School. Tip-off is 7:30 p.m.

NEC'S LAST STAND — Harvey is the last Northeastern Conference team remaining in a tournament. The NEC usually does not fare well on the district level. No. 1 seed Conneaut's loss to Perry last week was further evidence. Harvey coach Lonnie Miller seemed to distance Harvey from the NEC's failures.

"It's an honor to represent Harvey High and the city of Painesville," he said. "We don't feel we're carrying the burden" of the NEC.

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Bees deliver in clutch, then hold off Explorers

By TIM ROGERS
PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

The Brecksville-Broadview Heights basketball team came into the Division I sectional-district tournament at Copley as an unknown quantity.

It's a sure bet everyone knows them now, especially after last night. The unseeded Bees scored the game-winning basket with 20 seconds remaining then withstood two shots in the final seconds to outlast Hudson, 46-44, in a district semifinal that took 70 minutes to play and was the best and most competitive of the tournament thus far.

For years, Brecksville competed in the tournament at Baldwin-Wallace College. This year it was reassigned to Copley and no one knew what to expect. The school is the only one from Cuyahoga County in the 12-team tournament dominated by Summit County schools. When it came time to select the seeded teams last month, the Bees were ignored. Even their coach didn't vote for them. "We are the mystery team," said coach Dave Bielak. "We were not playing well at the time of the seeding meeting so we didn't expect to get seeded."

The Bees (17-6) are playing well now and advanced to tomorrow's district title game against Stow (15-5) after a one-year absence. But that was about 25 miles and another gymnasium ago.

"It's not new to us, but it's new being here," said Bielak, who guided the Bees to consecutive district title appearances in 1998 and 1999. "But we have six good seniors and we wanted to make a strong tournament run."

The Bees have done just that, culminating with Jim Wasko's layup off an assist from Dave Kallavig that broke a 44-44 tie with 20 seconds left.

Third-seeded Hudson (16-6) had two cracks to win at the end. First, junior Ryan Booth's 3-point shot from the corner glanced off the rim and went out of

DIVISION I	
BRECKSVILLE HUDSON	46
	44

bounds off a Brecksville player with two seconds remaining. His second 3-pointer hit the front of the rim as time expired.

"We didn't want to call a timeout because we knew what we could run off that set," said Hudson coach Wayne Watts.

The Explorers played without starting guard Jerud Getz and substitute forward Jason Phelps. Both players missed the game because of disciplinary reasons. Watts declined to comment.

Still, the Explorers came within a whisper of victory. They had a six-point lead with a little more than four minutes remaining, but guard Grant Urbanski made two clutch 3-pointers, one with four minutes to go that pulled the Bees to within three and another with 2:41 left that put the Bees on top, 42-40. The 5-9 sophomore also scored a 2-pointer in between and finished with a game-high 16 points.

Substitute guard Matt Zajac put the Bees on top, 44-42, but Booth answered by scoring his fifth basket of the second half, off an offensive rebound, with 1:10 to go.

The Bees controlled the ball until Kallavig found an opening and drove the lane before dumping the ball to Wasko, who banked in a layup.

"We were working for the last shot and I just found a lane," said Kallavig. "I spun off my guy and Jimmy was left open and I was able to get the ball to him."

Wasko, who scored eight of his 10 points in the second half, said the play was not diagrammed.

"It just happened," he said. "Their defense kind of broke down and Dave came down the lane and luckily he saw me."

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BILL KENNEDY / THE PLAIN DEALER

Brecksville's Nick Longa looks for a narrow opening between Hudson's Ryan Booth, left, and Phil Blickensderfer during Brecksville's victory in a district semifinal game.

NEWSWATCH

New site for SVSM game

FROM STAFF REPORTS

The need for more seats has prompted officials from the Ohio High School Athletic Association to move tomorrow's Division III district championship game between St. Vincent-St. Mary and New Middletown Springfield from Salem High to Youngstown State University.

Defending state champ and top-seeded SVSM is 21-1 and finished the season ranked first in Ohio. New Middletown Springfield was seeded second and was ranked 13th in Ohio.

SVSM ticket manager Linda Henretta said she has sold 1,000 tickets and will receive an additional 500 adult and 500 student tickets. They will be on sale today between 8 a.m. and 4 p.m. and tomorrow from 8 a.m. and 2 p.m. in the bookstore. Call 330-253-9113.

Catch The Hype

Join The Plain Dealer's Eddie Dwyer and the Cleveland.com sports staff today at 3:30 p.m. as they break down the latest boys and girls basketball tournament action. Get Eddie's take on who will advance and who will head home. You can submit a question and comment in the live chat room.

Miss the chat? Just log on for the audio archive all week long. Catch it all at www.cleveland.com/hssports/hype

DISTRICT PAIRINGS

Division I BALDWIN-WALLACE District Final Tomorrow	
(1) St. Ignatius (20-2) / Bedford (16-6)	Winner advances to the Cleveland State Regional
Division II MADISON District Final Tomorrow	
(1) Massillon Jackson vs. Uniontown Lake / Massillon 7:30	Winner advances to the Canton Memorial Civic Center Regional
Division III CANTON District Final Tomorrow	
(1) Massillon Jackson vs. Uniontown Lake / Massillon 7:30	Winner advances to the Canton Memorial Civic Center Regional
Division IV CANTON District Final Tomorrow	
(1) Massillon Jackson vs. Uniontown Lake / Massillon 7:30	Winner advances to the Canton Memorial Civic Center Regional
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BY THE NUMBERS

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Regionals

Division I ASHLAND

13 7 14 12-48
Toledo C.C. 11 12 13-49

Magnificat (28-5) / Warren 1-13, Tura 4-0, Stacey 3-19, Fox 8-11, Patton 4-0, Hagg 1-2

Toledo Central Catholic (23-2) / Kulp 6-6, Hagg 1-2, Burton 1-2, Uebachs 1-2, Brown 7-2, Warren 1-2, Coleman 1-2, Hagg 1-2

Palma 14 11 19 16-49
Celia 20 20 24-69

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